



Individual Instructor Report Summer 2025 Version A for STA F235 - DATA SCI FOR BUSINESS APPLCTNS (71775) (Henrique Bolfarine)

Project Title: **Course Evaluations Summer 2025**

Courses Audience: **20**

Responses Received: **18**

Response Ratio: **90.0%**

Report Comments

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness, multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor. For additional details, including the scales and how the Mean scores are calculated, please review the Report Guide at the end of this document or, [UT Austin's Viewing Course Evaluation Results webpage](#).

Creation Date: **Friday, August 22, 2025**

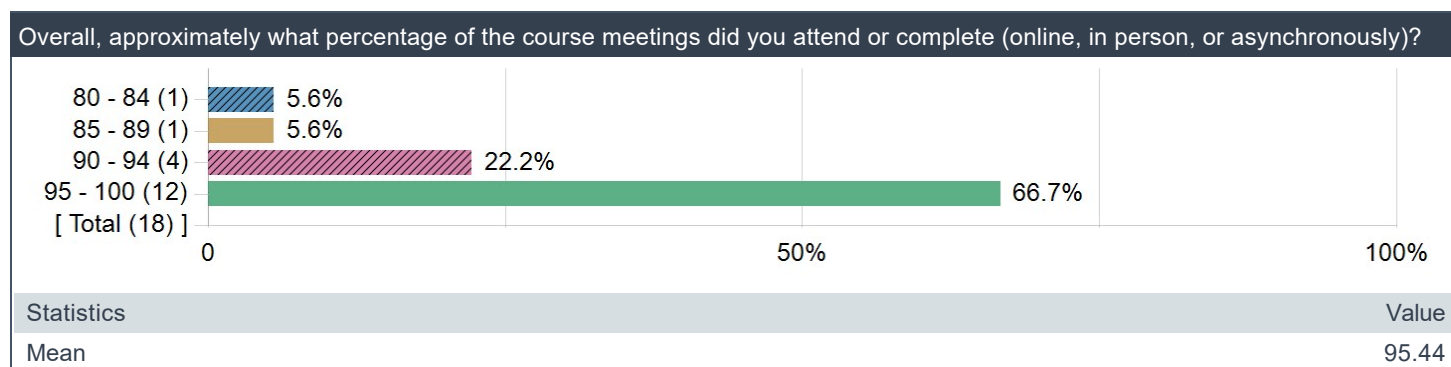
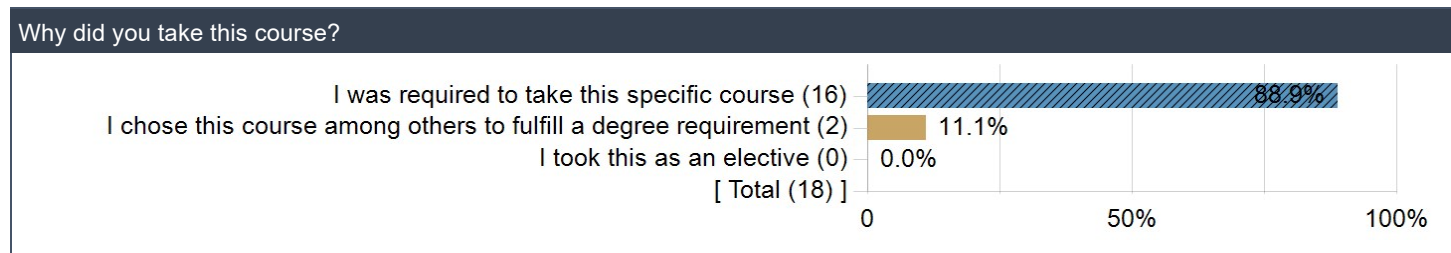
Core Questions

	Strongly Agree	Agree	Neutral	Disagree	Strongly Disagree	Responded	Mean
During this course, I gained a deeper understanding of the subject matter.	83.3%	16.7%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	18	4.83
The course was well organized.	72.2%	22.2%	5.6%	0.0%	0.0%	18	4.67
The instructor clearly explained the course objectives and expectations.	83.3%	16.7%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	18	4.83
The instructor fostered an inclusive learning environment.	83.3%	16.7%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	18	4.83
The instructor effectively explained the concepts and subject matter in this course.	83.3%	16.7%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	18	4.83
The instructional techniques kept me engaged in learning.	77.8%	16.7%	5.6%	0.0%	0.0%	18	4.72
The instructor checked for student understanding of the concepts presented in the course.	83.3%	16.7%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	18	4.83

Overall Questions

	Excellent	Very Good	Satisfactory	Unsatisfactory	Very Unsatisfactory	Responded	Mean
Overall, this instructor was	83.3%	16.7%	0.0%	0.0%	0.0%	18	4.83
Overall, this course was	72.2%	16.7%	11.1%	0.0%	0.0%	18	4.61

Other Course Questions



Comment Questions

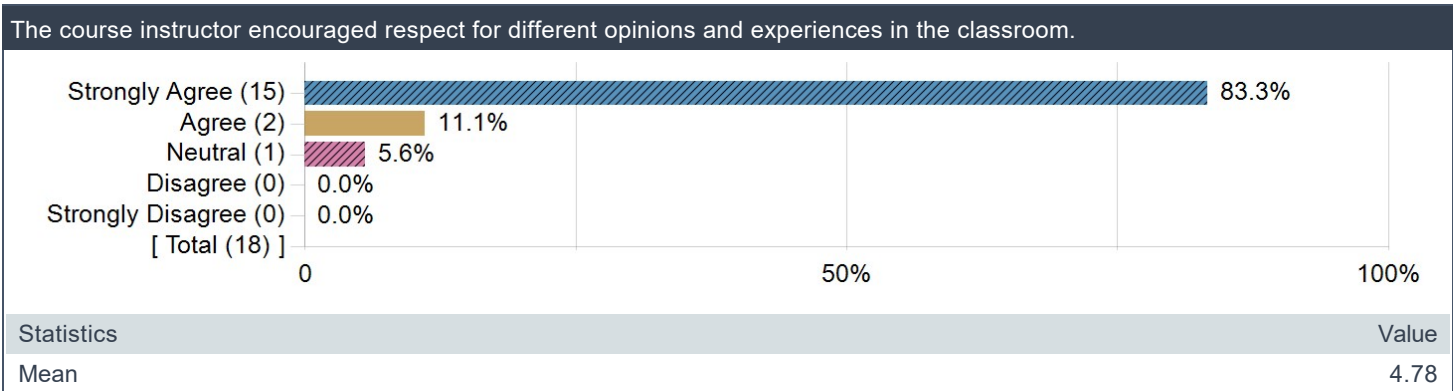
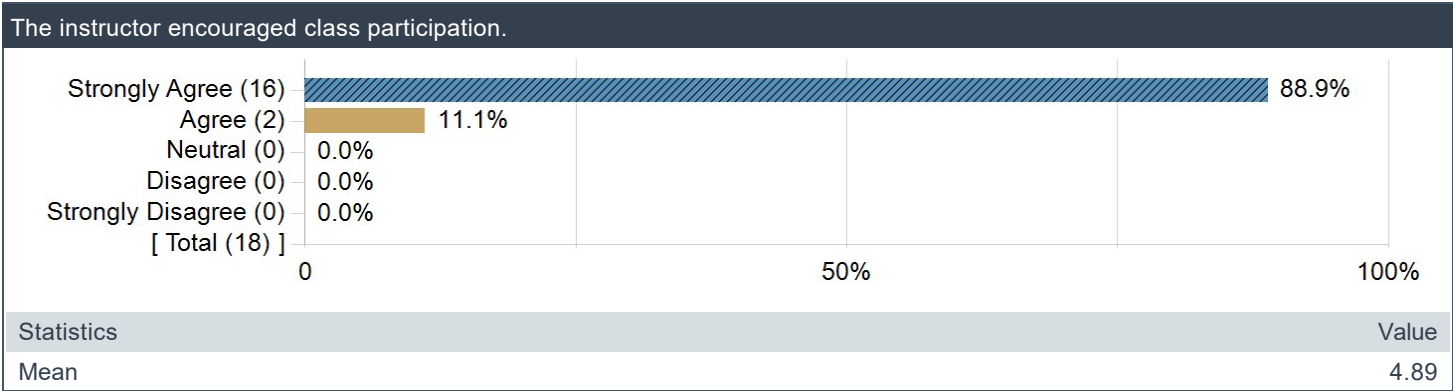
Identify aspects of the course that were the most effective in helping your learning.

Comments
I enjoyed the aspect where Professor Bolfarine walked through the code with us.
Doing the script with us and explaining as we went was great. I also liked how many times the professor went back and glossed over the content from prior classes.
I liked that the professor would go through practice problems and work them out in R–Studio for us during class that way I was listening to lecture as well as learning how to use R–studio in a more hands on way
his teaching style was magnificent. i took the pre req to this course and learned nothing but in a condensed semester i was able to learn what i didnt learn and so much more.
He explained the content very well and gave us lots of practice question with in depth explanations.
It helped a lot that we went over the basics of the course with the first exam. Made learning the other material a lot easier.
The structure of the lectures.
The lectures were effective. Also, having a well organized series of lessons published on Day 1, was very helpful. The recordings, the TA tutorial, and the homework structure that provides immediate feedback were all helpful. I feel like it would have been easy to get lost but I had all the tools to self correct. The repetitive nature of the early weeks was also really helpful, to focus on mechanics.
Lots of practice
I was able to learn and grasp very sophisticated and complex topics that had previously intimidated me,
The professor doing the r–scripts with us helped me the most
The detail of the course
Following along with Dr. Bolfarine was very helpful, especially when considering how my STA 301 professor did not teach us by allowing us to follow her in R Studio. Dr. Bolfarine is also very caring, thorough, and is ready to answer any questions.
in class every day
The teaching style. The professor had us following along with him, writing the r–code, and talking about the subject matter and its meaning was effective.
I believe the weekly quizzes are great at making sure the students review the material covered each week and ensure understanding of the topics covered, giving us time to test our knowledge and ask questions before the test.
I believe the day–to–day hands on work through R–studio and the repetitive nature of steps helped with retention and understanding.

Identify the aspect of the course that you found most challenging, why you found it was challenging, and suggest one thing that could be done to help future students meet that challenge more effectively.

Comments
I found the verbiage of the responses they were looking for the most challenging.
I think the most challenging was some of the content in the last unit. I thought it was kind of hard to ask the professor about questions I had about the review one-on-one during the last week. He was great, though.
I think that the most challenging part of the class was understanding the formulas and how to apply them to the script we were reading
the difficult concepts were difficult but they just take additional practice
I found some of the plot content kind of challenging. I would recommend spending more time on that.
I do not know I felt as if the pace for the second half of the class was quicker than the first half so maybe try to balance it out a little better.
Practice problem sets
My biggest struggle is correctly using Log, Exponentiating and executing these in R. Perhaps a one page refresher-tutorial going into the section would have been a benefit.
Hard content
The content is both complex and understandable. I wish that we had more time to go through more practice exercises to help cement knowledge more permanently.
The content was challenging at times.
The topics and material
The most challenging part is interpreting the data. It is easy to manipulate the data and use R to give outputs, but understanding the meaning behind the outputs is difficult.
I thought some of the HW and exam questioned were worded confusingly
I found the homeworks a bit challenging. The lectures were not an issue but applying the material in the homeworks took some effort. However, I'm glad with how they were structured since they aided my learning. Nothing else felt that bad.
I feel like this class is fast paced, especially the second half, so its easy to get lost if you do not put enough attention during class. However, I believe that paying attention is extremely helpful and makes it so much easier when having to study for quizzes or tests. Maybe one suggestion is to keep making it easier for students to ask questions whenever it is needed, that has helped me a lot this summer.
I think the hardest issue would be at how skilled you are at R-Studio can really give you either an advantage or disadvantage.

College, School, or Unit Questions



Report Guide

Guide to the Interpretation of Course Evaluations at UT Austin

The goal of course evaluation process at UT Austin is to drive teaching excellence and to support continuous improvement in teaching and learning experiences. The two sets of scales used for core evaluation questions and the associated weights are:

Strongly Agree (5)
Agree (4)
Neutral (3)
Disagree (2)
Strongly Disagree (1)

Excellent (5)
Very Good (4)
Satisfactory (3)
Unsatisfactory (2)
Very Unsatisfactory (1)

The Mean is calculated by adding all of the weights for a single question and dividing by the number of respondents. The course workload question is not averaged.

The number of students (e.g. respondents) marking each option is reported for each of the items. These frequency distributions provide information about the level of student ratings and the spread and shape of the class distribution of responses. The distributions thus provide a picture of student perception of a course.

Course evaluations provide snapshots of student perspectives on their course-level learning experiences. Most experts on teaching evaluation advise that no individual method gives the complete picture of an instructor's teaching effectiveness; multiple and diverse measures, on multiple occasions, are advised to give a full picture of the teaching effectiveness of a particular instructor. Moreover, other factors, such as size of class, level of the class, and content of the course, can cause small variations in the ratings. Therefore, student perspectives for a particular instructor or course should be interpreted as a snapshot, and not as providing complete information on the teaching effectiveness of that instructor.